Ryan Russell

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PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Resolut Salt Lake City, UT

Systems Administrator *April 2026—present*

IT Operations Assistant *February 2026—April 2026*

- Engineer and maintain internal IT systems by developing software that improves operational reliability, state management, documentation, and process efficiency.
- Build and maintain custom security monitoring capabilities using Machine Learning, Python, SQL, REST APIs, and log/event data to improve visibility across identity and operational security activity.
- Containerize internal tools and applications using Docker to improve portability, deployment consistency, and long-term maintainability.
- Develop scripting automations and stage IT systems, including ITSM platforms, to reduce manual work, improve department visibility, and strengthen operational maturity.
- Support hands-on IT operations across workstations troubleshooting, hardware deployments, endpoint maintenance, user support, server administration, and day-to-day infrastructure needs.
- Support hybrid cloud readiness, cloud migration initiatives, and cloud data exposure risk reduction through infrastructure assessment, access control awareness, implementation support, and oversight of rogue IT operations.
- *Technologies Used – Python, SQL, REST APIs, Docker, WSL, Windows Server, Microsoft 365, Azure*

Musician's Friend – Guitar Center Salt Lake City, UT

Sales Specialist / Customer Service Representative *May 2022—February 2026*

- Suggested a standardized software form for store submissions, enhancing the accuracy and efficiency of online product listings company-wide, which was successfully rolled out to production.
- Excelled in establishing, servicing, and maintaining a customer base in a fast-paced environment, consistently ranking as a top performer on the team since my first few months.
- Identified customer opportunities and issues, troubleshooting and resolving them across multiple channels (phone, email, chat) while creating, managing, and closing claims to ensure complete resolution and high satisfaction.
- Trained and mentored new teammates on sales techniques, product knowledge, and system usage to improve team performance.
- *Technologies Used* – Windows OS, Microsoft365, VoIP phone, Salesforce, Okta, Service Now, SAML

Salt Lake Community College Salt Lake City, UT

IT Lab Aid V *December 2022—December 2024*

- Reviewed and debugged student-developed applications, providing constructive feedback that enhanced code quality and functionality.
- Delivered one-on-one and group tutoring on software/hardware usage, empowering users to work independently.
- Educated students on industry standards and emerging technologies, bridging academic learning with real-world technical practices.
- Provided frontline technical support to faculty and students, troubleshooting hardware/software issues and ensuring seamless access to programs across Windows, Linux, and MacOS environments.
- *Technologies Used* – Microsoft Intune, Windows OS, Linux, MacOS, Node.js, React.js, Vue.js, SCSS, HTML, MySQL, PHP, GitHub, VSCode, Photoshop

Veterans First Mortgage Salt Lake City, UT

Trainer / Loan Assistant / Retention Specialist *November 2020—May 2022*

- Promoted through multiple roles, progressing from Retention Specialist to Loan Assistant and Trainer.
- Trained teammates on sales processes, credit pull procedures, and customer communication workflows while maintaining core responsibilities.
- Ranked as a top performer in retention and loan support, contributing to high-volume loan processing and customer relationship management.
- *Technologies Used* – Windows OS, Microsoft 365, VoIP phone systems, Salesforce, Workday.

EDUCATION

Financed 100% of education and living expenses through working part-time to full-time during the academic year and summers.

Western Governors University Salt Lake City, UT
Cloud Engineering Bachelor, Honors Student *December 2024—October 2026(Expected)*
Work full-time while enrolled in school
Supplemented academic studies with industry-recognized certifications:

- AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner, CompTIA A+ Certification, CompTIA Network +, CompTIA Security +, Linux Essentials Certificate

Salt Lake Community College Salt Lake City, UT
Computer Science Associate – Software Development Emphasis, Overall GPA 3.5 *May 2023—August 2024*
Work full-time while enrolled in school

- The National Society of Leadership and Success (Honors Society): Earned Advanced & Executive Leadership Certificate (communication styles, meeting management, critical thinking)

Utah State University Logan, UT
Computer Sciences/ GED, Overall GPA 3.79 *August 2019—May 2021*

- The National Society of Leadership and Success (Honors Society): Selected for leadership program; participated in peer coaching, goal-setting, and accountability teams.
- Lead Developer on Innovint talent-connection app; presented to classes and assembled expansion team.

Lone Peak Highschool Highland, UT

- GPA: 3.97
- NICA Mountain Biking Team (4 years)

Young Entrepreneurial Academy Sandy, UT

- Entrepreneurial training; Pitched and received seed funding for app work.

PERSONAL PROJECTS / EARLY DEVELOPMENT

https://portfolio-master-silk-nine.vercel.app/ *May 2021—Present*

- Built a personal portfolio website using React.js with Node.js/Express.js backend services to showcase early software development projects, technical growth, and hands-on experience with full-stack web technologies.

WeAre8 – Front-End Developer, Contract *February 2020—May 2020*

- Developed React.js front-end features, implemented Redux state management, integrated Firebase authentication, and collaborated in a Jira/GitHub-based development workflow.
- *Technologies Used* - Node.js, React.js, Express.js, GitHub, CSS/SCSS, HTML5, Bootstrap, Babel, Linux, AWS, Vercel

VOLUNTEER SERVICE

Highland City Highland, UT
May 2016—August 2018

- Established Beacon Hill Highland Bike Park by leading a team of mountain bikers in building and maintaining trails to grow the riding community.

SKILLS / CERTIFICATIONS

Cloud & Systems: AWS, Microsoft Entra, Microsoft Intune, Microsoft 365, Windows Server, Linux/Ubuntu, hybrid cloud readiness, cloud migration support
Automation & Development: Python, SQL, JavaScript, Java, PHP, REST APIs, scripting automation, data structures, state management, data persistence
Frameworks & Web Technologies: Node.js, Express.js, Next.js, React.js, Redux, HTML/CSS/SCSS, NPM
Security& IT Operations: Security monitoring, log/event analysis, access control awareness, endpoint support, ITSM platforms, documentation, process standardization
DevOps & Tools: Docker, Git/Github, Postman, Jira, VS Code, Vercel, WSL
Certifications: AWS Cloud Practitioner, AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Associate, CompTIA A+, CompTIA Network +, CompTIA Security +, Linux Essentials
Self-directed learning: Modern React with Redux; Data Structures and Algorithms in Python